

NANDINI PILLAI

Product Designer

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Right to work in the UK — no sponsorship required (Graduate visa, valid until Jan 2028)

EXPERIENCE

Baari (early-stage SaaS)

United Kingdom

Founding Product Designer

Apr'26 - Present

- Led **product strategy, design, and development** for **Baari, a business-first appointment-booking platform**, spanning a React Native mobile application and a web dashboard within a **two-person founding team**.
- Designed both product surfaces in full, from user flows to final UI; **co-developed the design system** and **independently established the complete brand and visual identity**.
- Conducted **user research with 5 pilot businesses**, translating findings into the product's **positioning and roadmap**.
- Advanced the product from concept to a **live pre-launch pilot**, implementing selected UI refinements in code using AI-assisted tooling (Claude Code).

ISS Innovation Hub, Lancaster University

Lancaster, UK

Product Designer

May'25 - Dec'25

- Sole designer for **LUCA, an AI careers platform in production**, delivering **19 features across 6 functional areas** from definition to release under GDPR, no-AI-training, and bias-audit constraints.
- **Reduced a core daily flow by 3 steps** by restructuring the information architecture after usability testing identified it as the primary point of failure.
- Established and governed a **design system spanning 80+ screens** for a live application serving **16,000+ students**.
- Led research with **40+ participants** across **5+ co-design workshops**, delivering **3 roadmap-level improvements** in partnership with engineering and product management.

Imagination Lab, Lancaster University

Lancaster, UK

Freelance Design Consultant (client: Yifei Wang)

Jan'25 - Apr'25

- Defined **product positioning and go-to-market strategy** for a UK early-stage startup, integrating UX, service design, and brand.
- Conducted **user and competitor research with 15+ participants** to prioritise the MVP feature set.
- Delivered a **strategy and roadmap adopted by the client**, shaping its positioning, investor narrative, and MVP plan.

Smartivity Labs Pvt. Ltd.

India

Product Designer

Oct'23 - Jul'24

- Led **end-to-end product design** for an interactive STEM product, validated through **5+ usability studies** that improved engagement and retention.
- **Reduced unit cost by 15%** by mapping user journeys and interaction flows to behavioural principles in collaboration with engineering.
- Extended UX across the **broader product range**, translating research insights into design decisions that held through manufacture.

Imagimake Play Solutions Ltd.

India

Design Intern

Dec'22 - May'23

- Designed **instructional systems that reduced support queries by ~20%** across **4+ product ranges**.
- Delivered **UX and concept design** from initial concept through to prototype iteration.
- Conducted **observational user testing** to refine usability and comprehension.

EDUCATION

Lancaster University

United Kingdom

MA Design Management

2024 - 2025

Symbiosis International University

India

Bachelor of Design (B. Des) – Product/Industrial Design

2019 - 2023

SKILLS

Product Design: End-to-End Product Design, Mobile & Web (iOS & Android), Interaction Design, Design Systems, Prototyping, Information Architecture, UI & Visual Design

Research: User Research, Usability Testing, Co-design Facilitation, Competitor Research, Heuristic Evaluation

AI & Building: AI Product Design, Prototyping in Code with AI Tools (Claude Code), Design-to-Code

Strategy & Ways of Working: Product Strategy, Service Design, Go-to-Market, Cross-functional & Agile Delivery, Stakeholder Management

Tools: Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, Adobe XD, Miro, FigJam